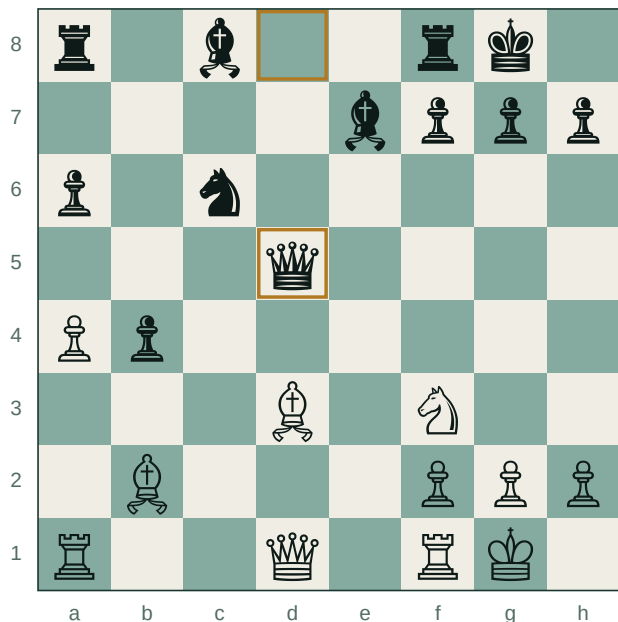


Discovered attacks: White, move 18

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 17...Qxd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18. Bxh7+ Kxh7 19. Qxd5

18.Bxh7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on d1 attacks the queen on d5. Recorded reply: **18...Kxh7**.

19.Qxd5 The queen captures the queen on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +7: the balance goes from -1 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on d5. Check for tactical protection.